



ECONOMICS IN 60 SECONDS

Issue #008

The Margin

Great decisions are rarely about everything. They are about one more.



TIMELESS IDEAS. EVERYDAY IMPACT.

FIVE MINUTES TO BOARDING

**One empty seat.
One last passenger.
Half the fare.**

The plane is about to leave with a seat unsold. A traveller appears at the gate and offers half the usual price. The flight departs either way. The fuel is bought, the crew is paid, the seat is empty.

Should the airline say *yes*?

FORGET THE TOTAL. WEIGH THE NEXT ONE.

That seat costs the airline almost nothing

The plane's full cost does not matter now. Only one number does: what one more passenger adds. A little fuel, a snack, almost nothing. Anything above that is pure gain.

COST OF ONE MORE PASSENGER



a snack and a sliver of fuel

WHAT THEY WILL PAY



far more

THE ONLY QUESTION THAT MATTERS

Two words behind
every smart choice

One more?

One more passenger

One more hire

One more hour

One more coffee

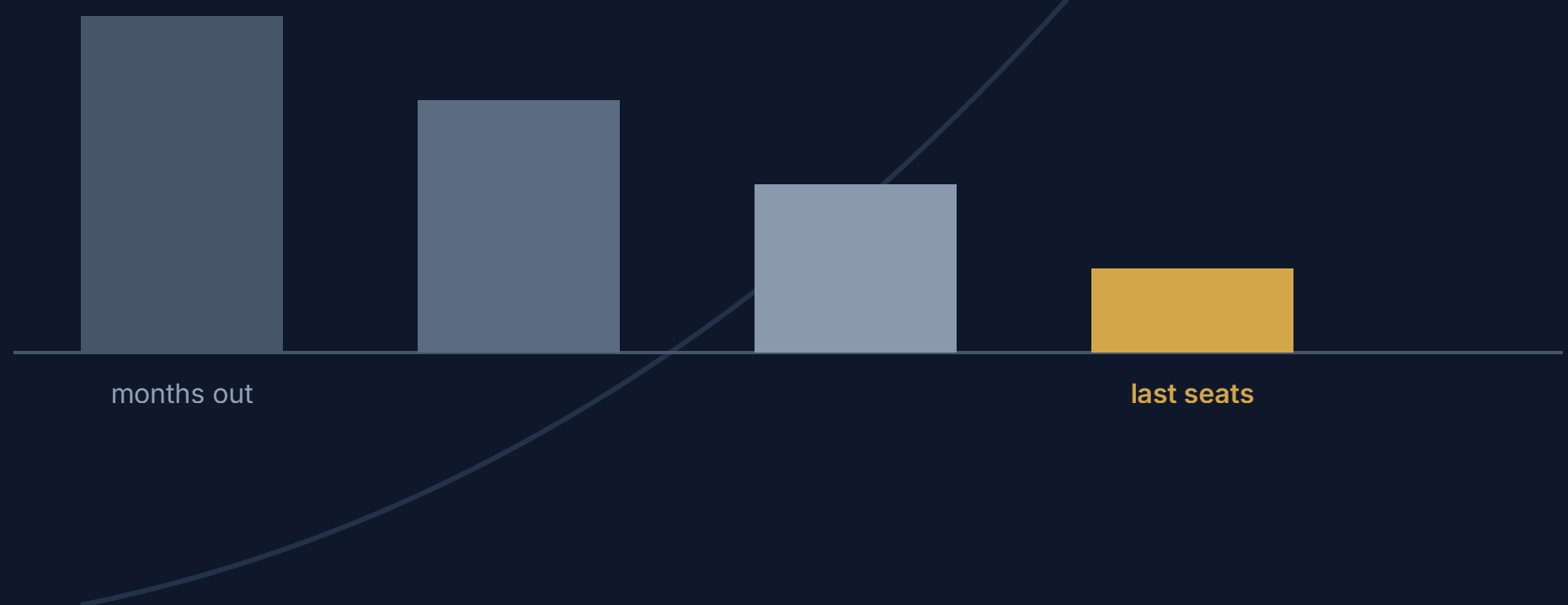
Do it while the next one adds more than it costs. Stop the moment it does not.

RYANAIR

Sell the last seats for the price of a sandwich.

Once a flight is scheduled, an empty seat earns nothing. So the late, cheap fare is not desperation. It is marginal thinking turned into a business model: any fare above the tiny cost of carrying you is profit the rival airline leaves on the ground.

fares fall as the empty seat's value falls



THE BOARDROOM QUESTION

Not "is it profitable?"
but "is the next one?"

One more hire

Worth it only if they add more than they cost.

One more advert

Spend until the last rupee stops paying its way.

One more unit

Produce while each one still beats its own cost.

One more store

Open it for what it adds, not what the chain earns.

The right question is never "is health worth it?" It is "what does the **next** rupee buy?"

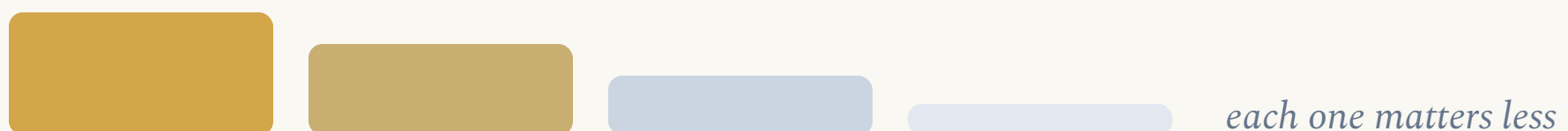
A government cannot fund everything. So the sharp question is marginal: does the next rupee do more good in a hospital, a classroom, or a road? Whole-versus-nothing debates miss it. The next unit is where the real choice lives.

YOU ALREADY DO THIS

The third slice is never the first

The first slice of pizza is bliss. The fourth is a struggle. Same pizza, different value, because what matters is never the whole, only the next bite. One more hour of study, one more episode, one more drink: you have weighed the margin your whole life.

VALUE OF EACH EXTRA SLICE





Where in your life are you judging the whole, when you should be weighing just the next one?

Name it below. The sharpest answer shapes a future issue.



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ONE IDEA. BETTER DECISIONS.

Next issue, #009 · Incentives

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